Regional Service Delivery and Automation Program Review - 2026

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Program Overview

The regional service-delivery program covers seven operational centers and three shared-service teams. Its purpose is to reduce manual case handling, standardize approvals, and improve reporting across customer onboarding, invoice exceptions, service restoration, and field-maintenance requests. The program started in January 2026 with an approved budget of $2.6 million. By the end of July, $1.14 million had been committed and $980,000 had been invoiced.

Volume and Performance

The centers processed 126,400 cases during the first seven months of the year. Average end-to-end handling time fell from 18.6 hours in January to 14.2 hours in July. The largest improvement came from automated classification of routine requests, which now covers 44% of incoming volume. Complex cases still require manual assignment and account for most of the remaining backlog.

Management Position

The executive sponsor approved continuation of the current automation roadmap through December 2026. A separate proposal to accelerate the program by purchasing an external decision-automation platform for $410,000 remains under review. Procurement is not authorized to issue a purchase order until the risk committee completes its assessment on October 6.

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Page 2 - Center-Level Results

Performance Variation

Five of the seven centers met the July target of fewer than 15 hours average handling time. Center North recorded 12.8 hours and Center West recorded 13.4 hours. Center South remained at 17.9 hours, while Center Coastal averaged 18.3 hours. The two slower centers also had the highest proportion of cases requiring manual document verification.

Backlog

Total open backlog declined from 9,420 cases at the end of March to 6,780 cases at the end of July. However, 1,120 cases were older than five business days. Of those aged cases, 63% originated in Center South or Center Coastal. Operations approved a temporary 10-person support team for six weeks beginning August 26 to reduce the aged backlog.

Quality

First-pass resolution increased from 68% to 74%. A sample audit of 600 closed cases found 27 cases with incorrect categorization and 11 cases where mandatory evidence had been attached after approval rather than before it. None of the 11 cases resulted in financial loss, but compliance classified the sequence as a process-control weakness requiring correction.

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Page 3 - Automation Components

Current Automation

The current platform performs intake classification, duplicate-case detection, simple policy checks, and automated routing. It does not make final approval decisions for high-value exceptions. Cases above $25,000, cases involving contract termination, and cases flagged for regulatory review must still receive human approval.

Accuracy Monitoring

Offline evaluation on 8,000 labeled historical cases showed 93.1% classification accuracy overall. Accuracy was 95.4% for English cases and 88.7% for Arabic cases. The largest Arabic error category involved short requests containing mixed Arabic and English product names. The data-science team proposed adding additional bilingual training examples, but no model retraining has been approved yet.

Guardrails

Three automated checks are currently enforced before a case can move to final review: amounts must match the source document, required dates must be present, and decision status cannot be changed from proposed or pending to approved without a recorded human action. During July, the guardrails blocked 184 cases for manual review. In 39 of those cases the block was caused by formatting rather than a true error.

Page 4 - Supplier and Field Operations

Supplier Performance

Two regional maintenance suppliers missed their contractual response-time target in June and July. Supplier A met the target on 82% of incidents and Supplier B on 79%, compared with the contractual requirement of 90%. The delays affected approximately 4.7% of all field-maintenance requests during the period.

Review Decision

Management approved a formal supplier-performance review to be completed by September 30. The review will assess delivery reliability, staffing, pricing, and alternative coverage options. No supplier contract will be terminated before the review is complete. A proposal to add a third supplier for emergency coverage has been drafted but has not yet been approved.

Field Automation

Technicians began using a mobile workflow for photo capture and completion notes on May 20. Adoption reached 81% by July. The main remaining issue is intermittent synchronization in locations with weak connectivity. Engineering approved an offline-queue enhancement scheduled for release on September 14.

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Page 5 - Financial and Risk Review

Financial Position

Program spending remains within the approved annual budget. Forecast committed cost for the full year is $2.42 million, leaving an expected $180,000 uncommitted if current plans remain unchanged. The proposed external decision-automation platform is not included in that forecast because it has not been approved.

Risk Register

The program currently tracks 16 active risks: 2 high, 7 medium, and 7 low. The high risks are inconsistent Arabic classification quality and dependency on two underperforming field suppliers. A previously high risk related to invoice-data reconciliation was reduced to medium after a validation rule lowered mismatched totals from 3.4% of sampled cases to 0.8%.

Data Governance

The data-governance team found 214 historical cases containing personal contact details that were not required for operational reporting. The team approved redaction of those fields in the analytics copy while preserving the source records under the existing retention policy. The redaction work must be complete by November 5.

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Page 6 - Roadmap and Decision Criteria

Q4 Roadmap

The approved Q4 roadmap includes the aged-backlog reduction initiative, the offline mobile enhancement, improved bilingual monitoring, and additional audit sampling. It does not include autonomous approval of high-value exceptions. Any expansion of automated decision authority requires a separate governance decision and documented validation results.

Success Criteria

The executive sponsor defined five conditions for the January 2027 continuation decision: average handling time below 13.5 hours, first-pass resolution of at least 78%, Arabic classification accuracy of at least 92%, aged backlog below 3,500 cases, and no unresolved high-severity compliance findings. Meeting four of five conditions will trigger an executive review rather than automatic approval.

Final Assessment

The program has delivered measurable efficiency gains and lower backlog, but the benefits are uneven across centers and languages. The strongest evidence supports continued process automation with human approval for sensitive decisions. The next formal program review is scheduled for December 12. The $410,000 external platform remains pending, supplier contracts remain active, and the approved program budget remains $2.6 million.

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